

ALAN PONTON

UX / Product Designer · Designs and Ships

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SUMMARY

Product-minded UX designer who owns the full arc from problem framing through interaction and visual design, prototyping, and detailed specifications, then ships the production build. I design commerce and product experiences under real constraints, partner with engineering from inception through implementation in agile, and defend design decisions with best-practice reasoning and business rationale. Because I build and deploy what I design, my interface and interaction work is grounded in what actually ships. Moderated and unmoderated usability testing and formal quantitative research are an area I am actively growing. Google UX Design and Meta Front-End certified.

SELECTED DESIGN WORK

2100 Security | Security Operations Platform *UX Designer & Full-Stack Developer (solo) · 2024–Present*

A progressive web app I designed and built for the five-person overnight security team I work on at a 33-floor Dallas high-rise. It replaced a broken legacy site and has evolved across three documented production versions, in nightly use.

- Designed the visual style, interface, and interaction flow end to end, then carried it through implementation myself, so design intent survived into the shipped product with no handoff loss.
- Derived requirements from direct observation of officers in real conditions such as low light, one-handed, and mid-patrol, and turned friction into hard constraints: dark-by-default, high-contrast, no horizontal scroll.
- Ran a V1 to V2 self-correction: my own visually impressive dark theme tested as unreadable across a long shift, so I reversed it and prioritized readability over aesthetics based on user feedback.
- Defended design decisions with explicit rationale, for example adding deliberate friction with employee-ID re-entry to confirm fire-extinguisher inspections, because a careless tap on a safety record is real-world harm.
- Built a deterministic constraint-based scheduling engine honoring five to seven simultaneous rules, and maintained detailed specifications and design patterns across versions.

Lonnie's Locations | Productized Group-Travel Platform *UX Designer & Full-Stack Developer (solo) · Dec 2025–Present*

End-to-end product design and build for an independent travel advisor with a high-touch business and no digital infrastructure. Live in production serving real guests.

- Designed conversion-oriented reservation flows matched to each trip's mental model, plus a passwordless guest portal with status microcopy that turns database states into reassurance.
- Mined the advisor's inbox as a qualitative dataset, with no research budget, to derive the recurring-question taxonomy behind the FAQ architecture and AI knowledge base.
- Caught and reversed my own designer-imposition failure, having designed an aspirational itinerary over the client's actual chosen plans, and made “design for who the user is” a governing principle.
- Designed an AI concierge as a conversation-design problem first, with deliberate refusal boundaries on pricing, medical, and refund questions, and suggested-question chips to lower the blank-prompt barrier.

ROSE | White-Label AI Front-Desk Agent *UX Designer & Full-Stack Developer (solo) · 2025–Present*

A conversational AI intake product for small businesses. Deployed to production at poweredbyrose.com; pre-revenue, verified end to end through developer testing.

- Designed and built an end-to-end lead-capture flow, from conversational AI intake to database persistence to owner email notification, on a Next.js serverless stack.
- Integrated Anthropic Claude with tool and function calling so the agent takes structured actions, capturing and persisting requests, while staying in voice.
- Designed a two-gate abuse front door, a bot challenge plus request-rate limiting, to protect the public endpoint without degrading legitimate users.

Additional Shipped Products *Solo, AI-augmented · 2025–Present*

- MetroPlex Match, a compatibility-first dating platform framed around optimizing for compatibility, not swipes.

- Trip Buddy, an AI travel companion with a modular wardrobe system and voice concierge, used personally on a real cruise.
- FollowThisModel, an AI-twin communication platform, pre-launch, built on a full multi-tenant and Stripe Connect architecture with no live transactions.

CAPABILITIES

Design Information architecture, interaction and visual design, conversation and AI UX design, content strategy and microcopy, accessibility (WCAG, reduced-motion), heuristic evaluation, wireframing, prototyping (Figma and coded React prototypes), usability iteration, detailed specifications and design patterns. Growing: moderated and unmoderated usability-testing tools, quantitative research methods.

Build React, TypeScript, Next.js 14, Node.js, Tailwind, Framer Motion; Supabase and PostgreSQL (schema, RLS, advisory-lock transactions, append-only ledger design); Anthropic Claude API (model tiering, tool calling, prompt-injection defense); Stripe Connect (built, pre-launch); AWS EC2, Docker, Caddy reverse proxy with Let's Encrypt TLS; Vercel, Cloudflare (Pages, DNS, Turnstile), Upstash Redis; Vitest, disciplined Git workflow; Figma.

Approach Constraint-driven product design, agile cross-functional delivery, ship-measure-iterate.

CREDENTIALS & EXPERIENCE

- Google UX Design Professional Certificate, Coursera, 2023.
- Meta Front-End Developer Professional Certificate, Coursera, 2024.
- Network Administrator, State of New Jersey, 2005–2019. 14+ years of enterprise and government IT and infrastructure.
- Application Developer, Experian (Fortune 500), 1998–2003. Enterprise data-processing systems.